D

“I’m Donna. I know everything.”

— DONNA PAULSEN, SUITS

BUILD YOUR OWN DONNA

No code. You copy, you paste, you leave with an agent.

DENISE GOSNELL, PH.D. · WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026

12:00 PM ET · 9:00 AM PT · 5:00 PM LONDON · 6:00 PM PARIS



BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

Open the instructions.

denisekgosnell.github.io/Donna

PASSWORD

donna2026

- Phone or laptop. Keep it open: every prompt has a copy button.
- The site is the live version. If they disagree, the site wins.

WHERE WE ARE WITH AI AT WORK

what you asked for
almost right
busywork
noise

Work you wanted: 1 in 10 seconds · Work you threw away: 0



AI, OPEN LOOP

After AI. Four times the output. The same ten you wanted. And you sort the rest.

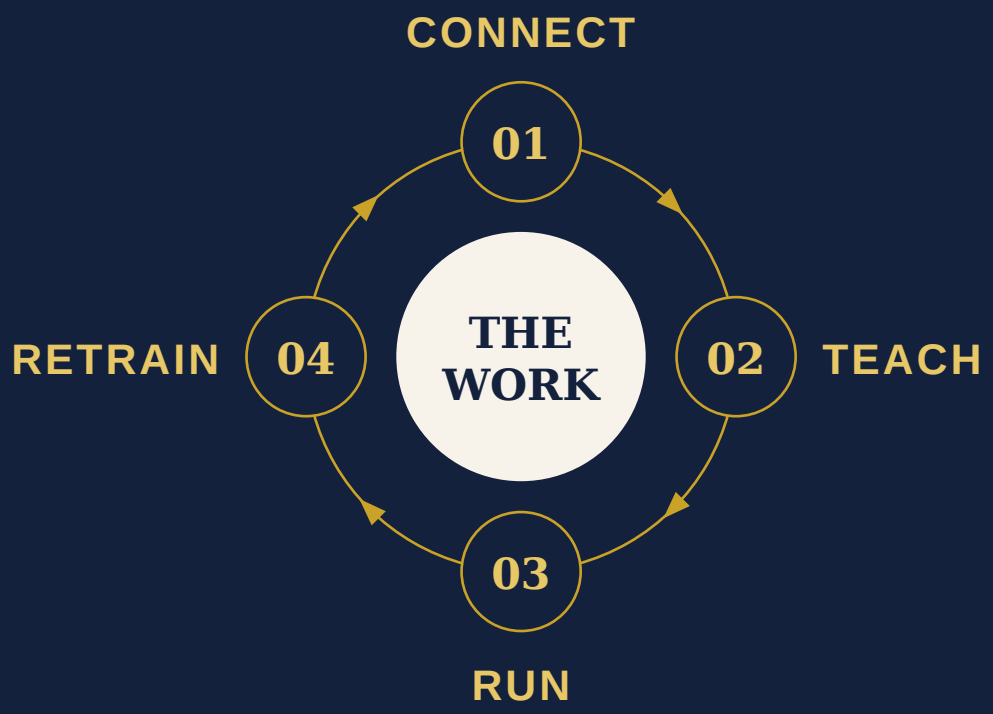
Open loops make more work. Closed loops make better work.



AI makes open loops cheap. That is the whole problem.

ANY WORKFLOW YOU CAN DESCRIBE

Every workflow is a loop.



01 CONNECT

Work comes in.

02 TEACH

Write the rules down once.

03 RUN

The work gets done, on a schedule.

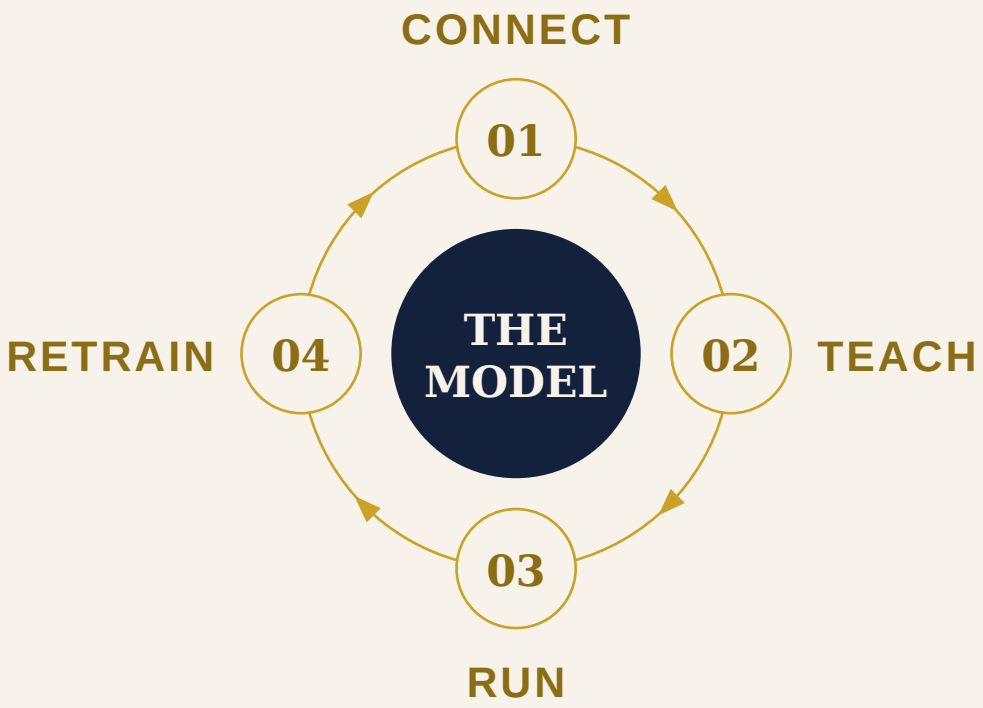
04 RETRAIN

Look at what came back. Fix the rules.

Email. Invoices. Hiring. Support tickets. Same four stops.

WHAT MACHINE LEARNING ACTUALLY IS

Machine learning runs this loop.



01 CONNECT

Collect the data.

02 TEACH

Train the model on it.

03 RUN

Put it to work and watch what it does.

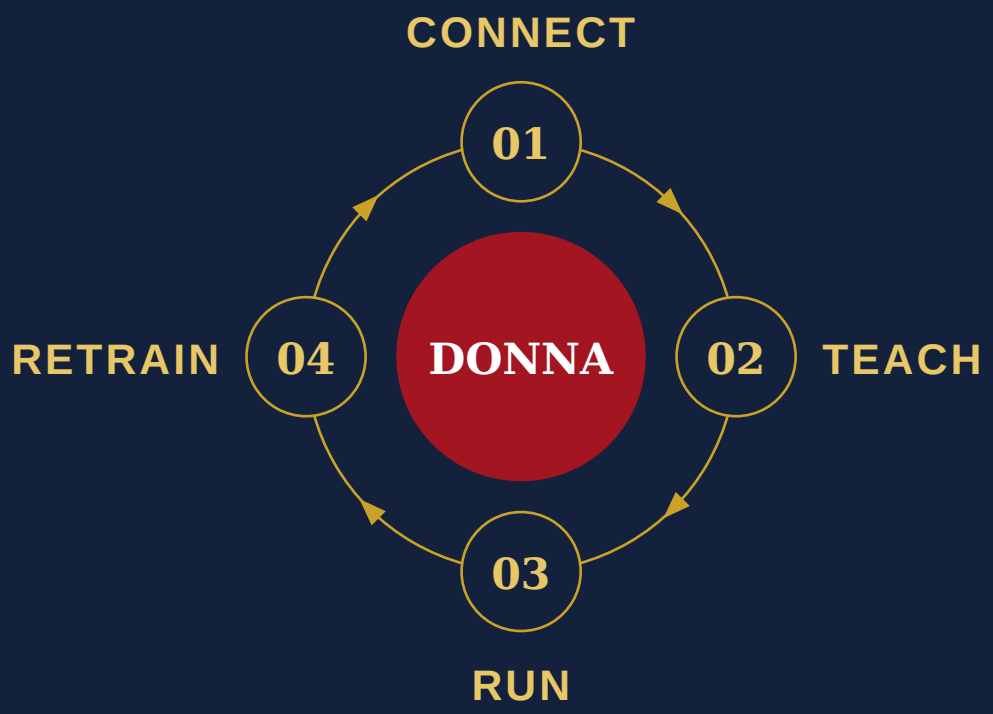
04 RETRAIN

Compare to what you wanted. Retrain.

Over fifty years of this loop. The prompt was never the hard part. Step four was the job.

WHAT YOU BUILD IN THE NEXT HOUR

An agent is just a document.



01 CONNECT

Connect her to your inbox and calendar.

02 TEACH

Four questions. She writes her playbook.

03 RUN

She takes the 4:30 shift, every weekday.

04 RETRAIN

Fridays she reviews her week. You sign it.

You are not retraining Claude. You are retraining Donna. And Donna is a document you own.

What my Donna does for me.

- **Holds the calendar.** A thread picks a time. The hold is already on my calendar.
- **Checks the guest list.** Every invite, scanned. The people who matter are on it.
- **Preps me for strangers.** A one-page brief before I meet anyone new, in my inbox and Drive.
- **Eggs versus balls.** She watches my real goals and warns me before I drop an egg.
- **Reads every Slack channel.** All of them. I read one briefing.
- **Runs the 24-hour reply desk.** No real email goes a day without an answer or a holding reply.
- **Plans tomorrow at 4 PM.** Before I log off, tomorrow is laid out: meetings, prep, buffers, risks.

All of it from one playbook, written in plain English. Today you write yours.

THE RECEIPTS

What she gives back.

3.5 hrs

saved on post-conference follow-ups. Four hours by hand. Thirty-three minutes with Donna, the Friday after a conference.

35

personalized one-to-one event invitations, written in 75 minutes. Before Donna: not possible, so not done.

100+

meeting briefs since August 7, one per meeting, written before I walk in. 27 prep blocks on my calendar in the last 30 days.

◆ **Published benchmark:** Microsoft's first 297 Copilot users reported 64% less time on email and 1.2 hours a week back. (Work Trend Index, November 2023)

WHICH AI?

Pick your tool. Keep your playbook.

Copilot

AI inside Microsoft 365. Pick it if your company lives in Outlook and Teams.

Perplexity

Research with sources. Ask the web, get the citations.

ChatGPT

The everyday all-rounder, with the widest set of tricks.

Claude

Careful writing, plus agents that do the work: projects, connectors, skills, scheduled tasks.

What you build today is a plain-text playbook. Download it, and paste it into any of these tomorrow.

She never sends. Ever.

She never deletes. She reads your inbox and your calendar, writes drafts, and puts events on your calendar. That is her whole job, and it is written into her playbook.

Written into the skill itself: “Never send anything. Never delete anything.”

HOUSE RULES

Five of them.

1. She never sends. Drafts only. You are the send button.
2. She never deletes. Nothing we do today is destructive.
3. We move together. Every step ends at a checkpoint: type ✓ in the chat.
4. Copy buttons everywhere. Nobody types more than a sentence.
5. No question is too small. Stuck for 60 seconds? Say so in the chat or raise your hand. A TA takes you into a Zoom room, 1:1.

If anything I just said did not compute, perfect. You are exactly who this is for.

THE PLAN, EASTERN

Four steps. By 1:13 she’s working for you.

01

CONNECT

A desk, your inbox, her first draft.

12:17

02

TEACH

Four questions. She writes her playbook.

12:31

03

RUN

Her playbook becomes a skill on a schedule.

12:45

04

RETRAIN

One more task: Fridays she reviews her week.

1:01

Nobody types anything longer than one sentence today. Every prompt has a copy button on the site.



CONNECT

STEP ONE · CONNECT

First impressions.

Give her a desk, connect your inbox, and watch her read it.

IN THIS STEP

1/ Create her project.

2/ Connect Gmail, Calendar, and Drive.

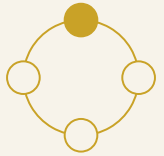
3/ Two prompts: the question, then the first draft.

Now go to the instructions: Step 1 on the site.

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STEP ONE · FIRST IMPRESSIONS

Create her project, then connect.



CONNECT

THE SETUP

- Projects, New project. Name it Donna.
- Customize, then Connectors.
- Connect Gmail, Calendar, and Drive.

- **Still stuck?** Say so in the chat or raise your hand. A TA takes you into a Zoom room, 1:1.

PROMPT 1 · THE QUESTION

```
What landed in my inbox in the last 24
hours that actually needs ME? Top 5, one
line each.
```

PROMPT 2 · THE FIRST DRAFT

```
Draft a reply to #1. Under 100 words,
warm but decisive. Read my sent emails
and learn how I write. Never use em
dashes. Never use AI speech patterns.
Save it as a draft. Do not send it.
```

A draft you didn’t write is waiting in your drafts folder.

The interview is over. She’s hired. Now we teach her.



TEACH

STEP TWO · TEACH

The triage desk.

Four questions. She writes her own playbook.

IN THIS STEP

1/ Paste her playbook into a new chat.

2/ Answer her four questions. Take your time.

3/ Type: Triage my inbox.

Now go to the instructions: Step 2 on the site.

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STEP TWO · THE TRIAGE DESK

This is the document. She writes it.

TEACH

PASTE INTO A NEW CHAT IN YOUR DONNA PROJECT

```
Here is my triage playbook template. Read it, then run
its Setup Interview on me exactly as written: four
questions, one question at a time, and give me time to
answer. Start now with your greeting and Question 1 of
4.

[the full template rides along in the same paste. One
copy button on the site, Step 2.]
```

- **Take your time. The better you answer, the better she works.**

THE FOUR QUESTIONS

- **1 · Reply Now** the 3 to 5 who never wait
- **2 · By End of Day** your team
- **3 · Your priorities** one to three, right now
- **4 · Your voice** three words and a sign-off

TEACH

You get one table instead of an inbox.

THE ENTIRE DAILY RITUAL, FROM NOW ON

```
Triage my inbox.
```

Chat is a conversation. A playbook is a standing arrangement.



RUN

STEP THREE · RUN

Donna, full time.

The document leaves your hands and goes on the clock.

IN THIS STEP

1/ She writes her playbook file.

2/ You upload it as a skill.

3/ Schedule the 4:30 shift.

Now go to the instructions: Step 3 on the site.

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STEP THREE · HER PLAYBOOK

She writes her own playbook file.

RUN

PASTE IN THE SAME CHAT, AFTER YOUR FIRST TABLE

```
Turn this conversation's triage setup into a reusable
skill named donna-triage. Fill in the template with
everything you learned about me. Keep the daily shift,
the Friday retrain, and the Setup Interview. Keep the
hard rules: never send, never delete. Give me the
skill as a downloadable zip named donna-triage.zip
containing donna-triage/SKILL.md.
```

◆ **Full prompt on the site, Step 3. See donna-triage in your skills list before anyone touches Scheduled.**

THEN THE HANDOFF

1. She writes the file.
2. Download it: the file card's arrow.
3. Customize, Skills, +, Create skill, Upload a skill. Pick the zip.

STEP THREE · THE 4:30 SHIFT

Give her the 4:30 shift.

RUN

SCHEDULED · NEW TASK · CREATE WITH CLAUDE

```
Every weekday at 4:30 PM my local time, use my
donna-triage skill: triage today's inbox, save the
Reply-Now drafts to my email Drafts, create a 5-minute
calendar event 10 minutes from now titled "Inbox
Triage: Donna", write the whole report into the event
description (short lines, no tables), and set an EMAIL
reminder 1 minute before. Also do a dry run right now
so I can watch the first one land.
```

- **Full prompt on the site, Step 3. Paste by 12:56.**

4:30 she works

4:39 the email lands

4:40 one read, whole inbox

- Runs on Claude's side, laptop closed.
- Paid plans only. Free: run her by hand.



1:01

Her first shift lands as the last step starts.

The trick: Claude never emails you. Your calendar does.

Three stations lit. One left, and it is one more scheduled task.



RETRAIN

STEP FOUR · RETRAIN

Her performance review.

One more scheduled task. Every Friday she reviews her week. You sign it.

IN THIS STEP

1/ Schedule the Friday retrain.

2/ Watch her first review land at 1:13.

3/ Monday: sign it.

Now go to the instructions: Step 4 on the site.

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STEP FOUR · THE FRIDAY RETRAIN

Fridays, she reads her week.

RETRAIN

SCHEDULED · NEW TASK · CREATE WITH CLAUDE

```
Every Friday at 3:00 PM my local time, use my
donna-triage skill to retrain: read this week's triage
reports, drafts, and the emails I actually sent.
Compare. Propose changes to my playbook: people,
priorities, voice. Keep the hard rules. Put "Donna's
Week in Review" on my calendar Monday 8:00 AM with an
EMAIL reminder and save it to a Drive folder called
"Donna". Also do a dry run right now on this week so
far.
```

- **Full prompt on the site, Step 4. Paste by 1:03.**

SHE LOOKS AT

- her reports
- her drafts
- your sent emails

WHAT COMES BACK

- changes, with a why
- you approve first

This was never about email.

You built a loop today by writing plain English. Rules became a project, the project became a skill, the skill got a schedule, and the schedule got a Friday.

Email was the rehearsal. The same loop runs any workflow you can describe in words.



THE LOOP IS CLOSED

1:13

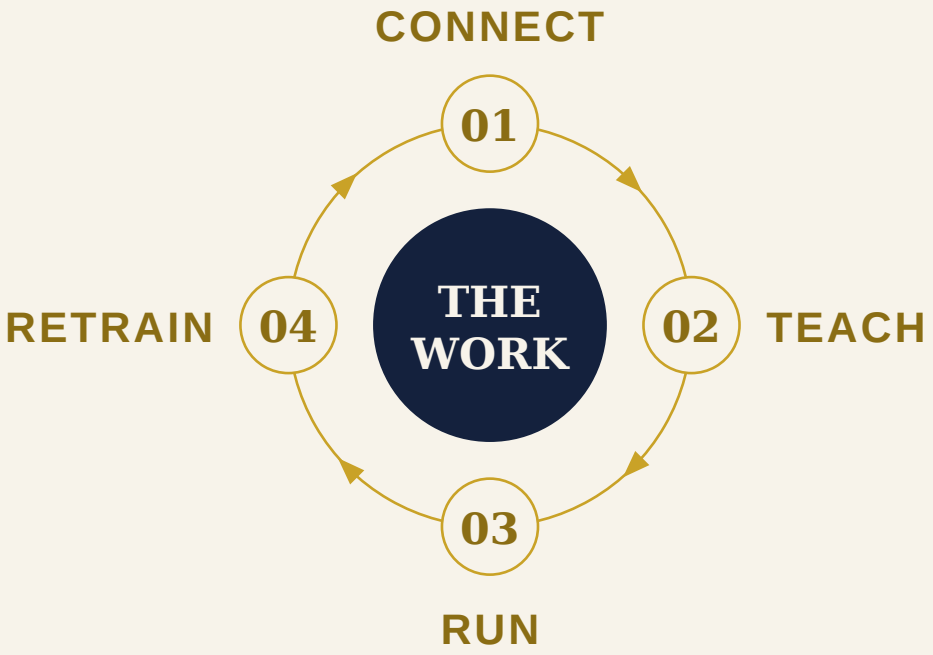
Her first Week in Review is on your calendar.

Four stations. Connect, teach, run, retrain. That is a learning system, and it is yours.

The loop is closed.

THE DISCUSSION

Where does the loop turn next?



- **CONNECT:** What arrives every day that you read by hand?
- **TEACH:** What do you re-explain to somebody every single week?
- **RUN:** What would you want running at 4:30 tomorrow without you?
- **RETRAIN:** What did you learn last month that nobody wrote down?

Answer any one of these out loud and you have just specified your next agent.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Your first Friday.

Thu 4:30
her first real shift

Fri 3:00
her first real retrain

Mon 8:00
her Week in Review, on your calendar

Mon, you sign it
one paste, one upload

◆ **If she gets it wrong, you do not need a better prompt. You need to retrain with better info, and more specific info.**

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> ***“If you were ever lucky enough to have me, you wouldn’t want to share.”***
>
> **— DONNA PAULSEN, SUITS**

Yours starts tomorrow at 4:30.

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